Justin D. Norman

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Current Position

California Department of Technology **Sacramento, CA**
Senior AI Science Advisor *Jan 2026–Present*
Embedded via the California Council on Science and Technology (CCST). In collaboration with the academic research community, industry AI and software labs, federal labs, government agencies, and nonprofit organizations, contributes to recommendations on frontier AI safety to the California Legislature.

UC Berkeley, School of Information **Berkeley, CA**
Research Scientist *Nov 2025–Present*
Advisors: Michael U. Rivera and D. Alex Hughes

Education

University of California, Berkeley
Ph.D., Information Systems *2026*
Concentration: Computer Vision & Machine Learning
Advisor: Hany Farid

University of Southern California, Marshall School of Business
M.B.A. *2015*
Concentration: Business Analytics

University of Southern California
M.S. Certificate, Technology Commercialization *2015*

United States Naval Academy
B.S., Computer Science *2007*

Research Agenda

My research is focused on computational evaluations of the impact that AI/ML proliferation and normalization have on society. I develop computational methods for deepfake detection and digital forensics, evaluate LLM and VLM robustness through repeatable and expert-grounded benchmarks, and study the ethical implications of AI systems, including how LLM chatbots may influence users' moral reasoning. This work bridges computer science, information science, and the social sciences.

Publications

2026: J.D. Norman, M.U. Rivera, and D.A. Hughes. "Reliability without Validity: A Systematic, Large-Scale Evaluation of LLM-as-a-Judge Models Across Agreement, Consistency, and Bias." *Under review*.

2026: N. Doering and J.D. Norman. "Formulation of Personal Ethics in Conversation with LLMs." *Under review*.

2026: J.D. Norman and S. Barrington. "Audio Deepfake Detection Using Temporal Coherence Analysis." In *Proc. APSIPA Annual Summit and Conference (ASC)*, 2026. Accepted.

2026: J.D. Norman. "When 95% Accuracy Isn't Good Enough: Bridging the Gap Between Forensic Biometric Facial Recognition Benchmarks and Real-World Human Impact." In *Proc. IEEE/CVF CVPR, Workshop on Humans of Generative AI (HuG)*, 2026.

2026: J.D. Norman and H. Farid. "Detecting Deepfake Talking Heads from Facial Biometric Anomalies." In *Proc. IEEE/CVF WACV, Workshop on Safe AI for All Domains (SAFE)*, 2026.

2026: J.D. Norman, D.A. Hughes, and M.U. Rivera. "The Case for Repeatable, Open, and Expert-Grounded Hallucination Benchmarks in Large Language Models." In *Proc. ICICT*, 2026. Oral presentation.

2026: J.D. Norman and H. Farid. "Does Head Pose Correction Improve Biometric Facial Recognition?" In *Proc. ICPR, Workshop on Physics-Aware Video Generation and Restoration (PAVER)*, 2026.

2025: J.D. Norman and N. Doering. "A FASPE Study of the Personal Ethics of Large Language Models." *FASPE Journal*.

2024: J.D. Norman and C.D. Whitney. "Real Risks of Fake Data: Synthetic Data, Diversity-Washing and Consent Circumvention." In *Proc. ACM FAccT*, 2024.

2024: J.D. Norman and H. Farid. "An Investigation into the Impact of AI-Powered Image Enhancement on Forensic Biometrics." In *Proc. IEEE/CVF CVPR Workshops*, 2024.

2023: J.D. Norman, S. Agarwal, and H. Farid. "An Evaluation of Forensic Facial Recognition." *arXiv:2311.06145*, 2023.

2021: J.D. Norman, P. Skomoroch, and M. Loukides. *Product Management for AI*. O'Reilly Media, 2021.

Select Professional Experience

Vera AI — **San Francisco, CA**
Chief Technology Officer / Head of AI — *2022–2025*
Led AI/ML strategy and engineering for content authenticity and deepfake detection platform.

Defense Innovation Unit, U.S. DoD — **Mountain View, CA**
AI/ML Portfolio Director (Acting) — *2023–2024*
Directed AI/ML investment portfolio; coordinated prototype-to-production transitions across DoD services.

Yelp — **San Francisco, CA**
Vice President, Data Science — *2019–2022*
Led organization of 50+ data scientists and ML engineers across product, ads, and trust & safety.

Cloudera Fast Forward Labs — **San Francisco, CA**
Director, Research & Machine Learning — *2018–2019*
Directed applied ML research; published reports on NLP, computer vision, and interpretability.

Fitbit — **San Francisco, CA**
Senior Manager, Applied Machine Learning — *2018*
Led ML team for health and fitness product features.

Cisco Systems — **San Jose, CA**
Senior Manager, Enterprise Data Science — *2016–2018*
Built and managed enterprise data science practice across business units.

Booz Allen Hamilton — **Washington, DC**
Network Integration Engineer — *2014–2016*
Designed and implemented large scale data platform and analytics infrastructure for enterprise and defense clients.

United States Marine Corps — **Various**
Officer — *2007–2011*
Strategic Communications and Systems Intelligence; deployed in support of overseas operations.

Awards & Fellowships

2024: FASPE Design & Technology Fellowship

2020: Marcus Foster Fellowship, UC Berkeley

Certifications

2023: Project Management Professional (PMP), renewed

2017: INFORMS Associate Certified Analytics Professional (aCAP)

Service

Berkeley Public Interest Technology Clinic — **UC Berkeley**
Technical Director — *2025–Present*
Deploy data science and technology projects for civic impact, including engagements with the U.S. Treasury, Habitat for Humanity, and MLT.

Digital Security, Safety, and Trust Search Committee — **UC Berkeley School of Information**
PhD Representative — *2025*
Participated in faculty search process for new tenure-track position.

INFO 290T: Computer Vision — **UC Berkeley School of Information**
Graduate Student Instructor — *Fall 2022*